

The fifth golden signal

making accessibility observable

Who is Victoria?

- Tech Support Intern @ VictoriaMetrics
- UX Designer
- Writer/Speaker
- Morbid fear of snakes
- Waiting for S5 of Lincoln Lawyer

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The four golden signals

Latency

how long it takes to serve
a request

Traffic

how much demand is being
placed on the system

Error

the rate of requests that
fail

Saturation

how "full" the system is

Why do we monitor them?

User-centric focus

They measure what the user actually experiences

Faster troubleshooting

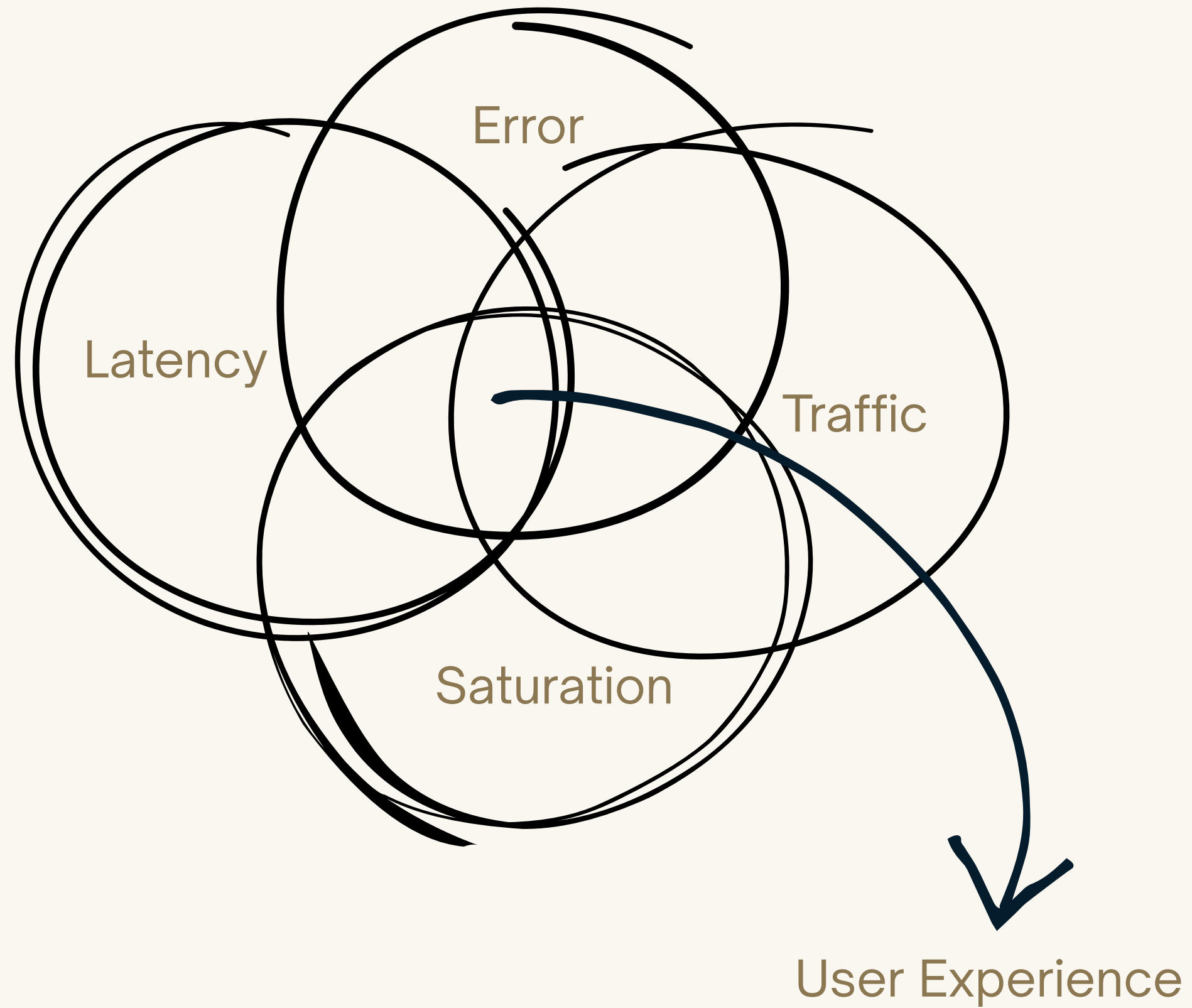
They lower the time it takes to detect and fix system issues.

Early problem detection

They catch performance drops and failures before users start complaining.

Capacity planning

They help predict when a system will run out of resources under heavy load



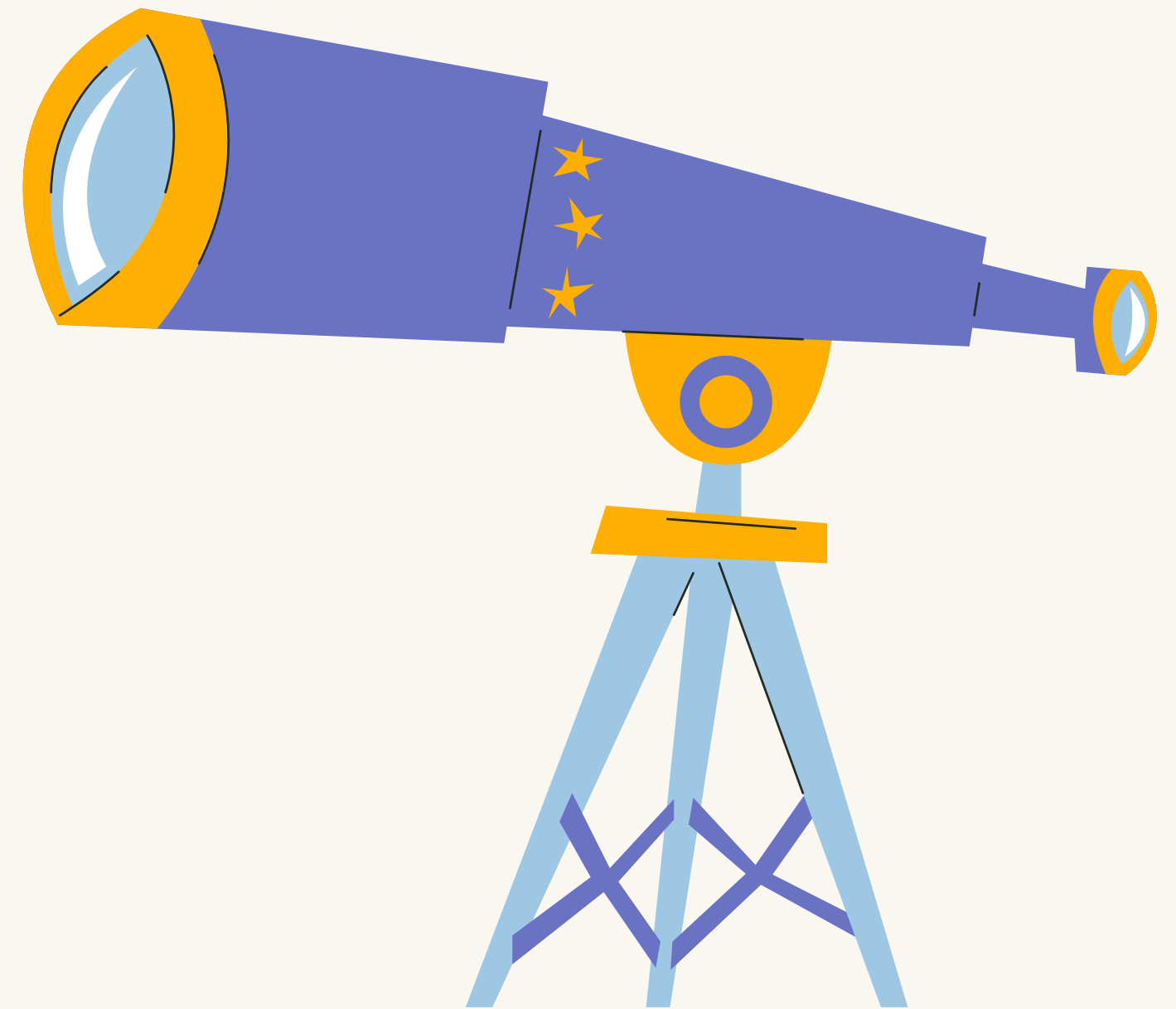
What is accessibility?



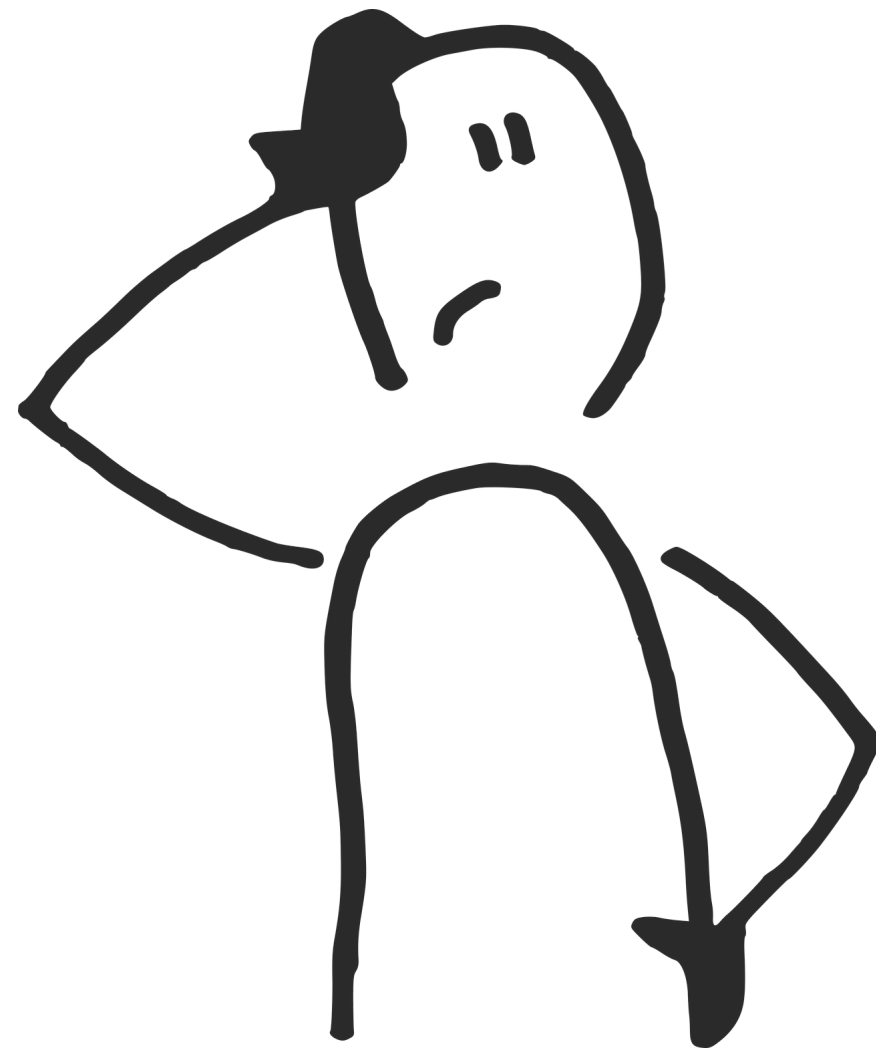
Accessibility is the design of products, devices, services, or environments to be usable by everyone, **including people with disabilities.**

What is observability?

Observability is the ability to understand a system's internal state or condition solely by analyzing its external outputs, such as logs, metrics, and traces



How might we ...



... measure how well people with disability can use our product/service?

How is accessibility measured?



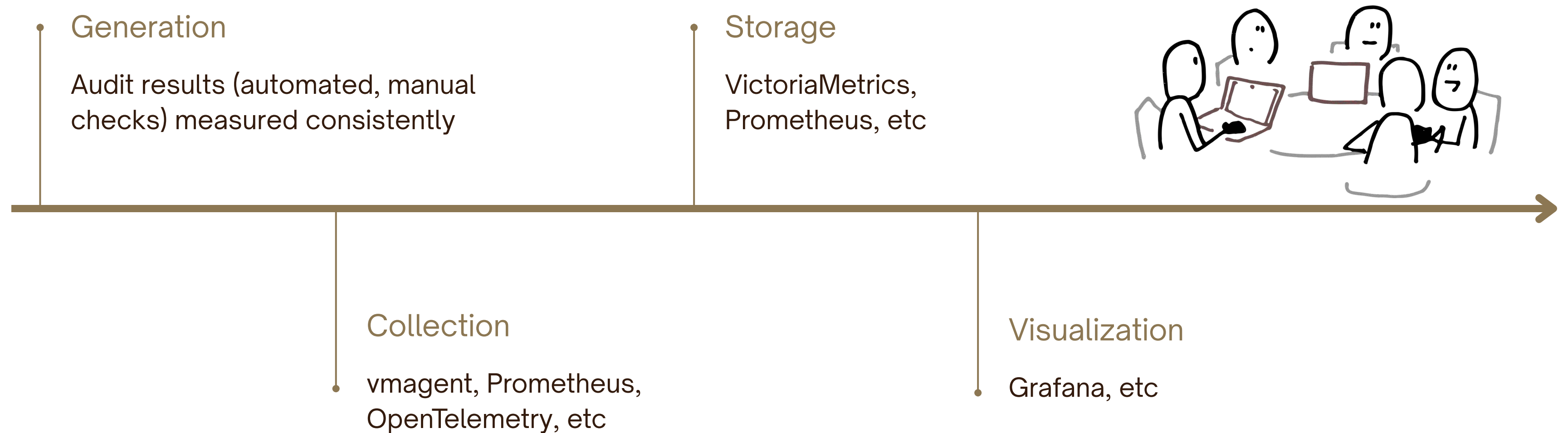
Compliance percentage

Health and quality scores

Error density

Conformance levels

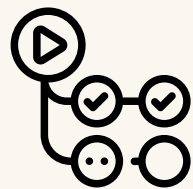
What would accessibility telemetry look like?



What this looks like in practice

1

GitHub actions to run axe-core
a11y checks daily



2

Results sent to Grafana Cloud
via Graphite



3

Set up dashboards to monitor
important a11y metrics



Link to repo/workflow:

<https://github.com/nwanduka/website/actions/runs/25378136223/workflow>



Posts

Jan 26, 2026

[The Journey of a Log: Understanding the Log Lifecycle](#)

Dec 30, 2025

[What You Need to Build a Website](#)

Dec 25, 2025

[Observability Basics: What Logs Are and Why They Matter](#)

Oct 31, 2025

[How Non-Developers Can Contribute to Prometheus](#)

Sep 29, 2025

[How to Leverage Hacktoberfest to Start and Grow Your Open Source Career](#)

Sep 3, 2025

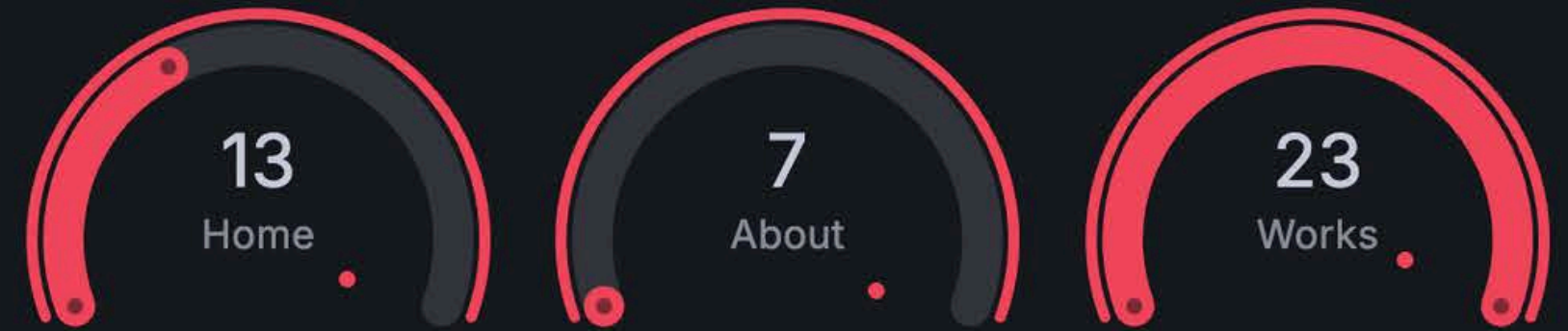
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Total Violations

43

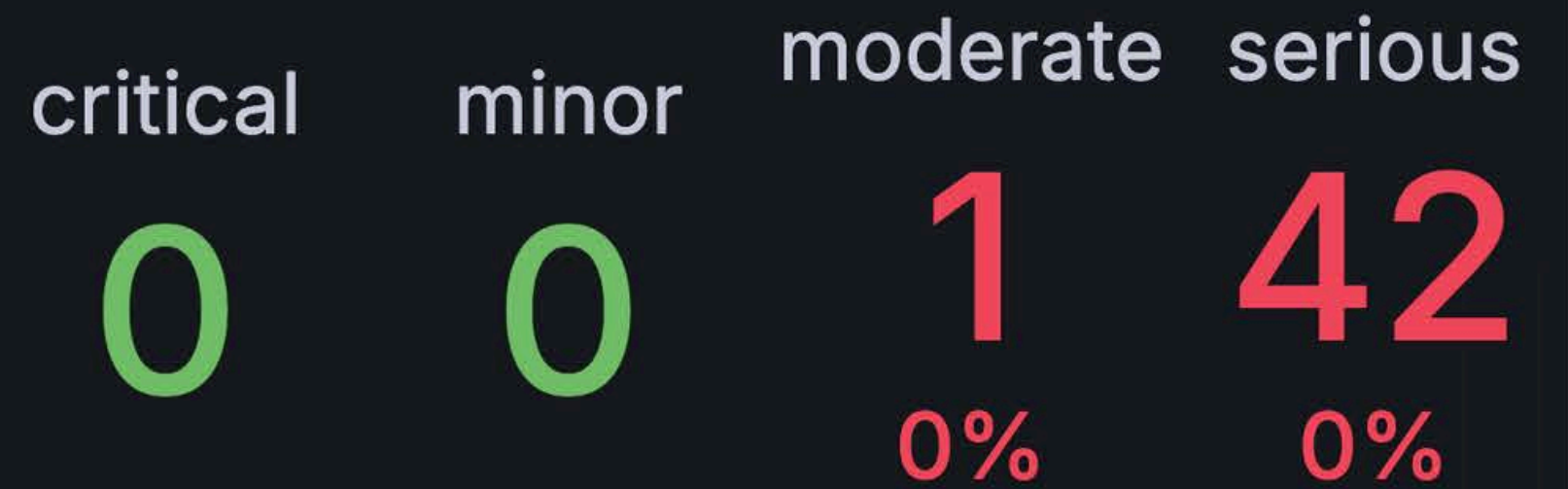
Violations by Page



Accessibility Violations Over Time



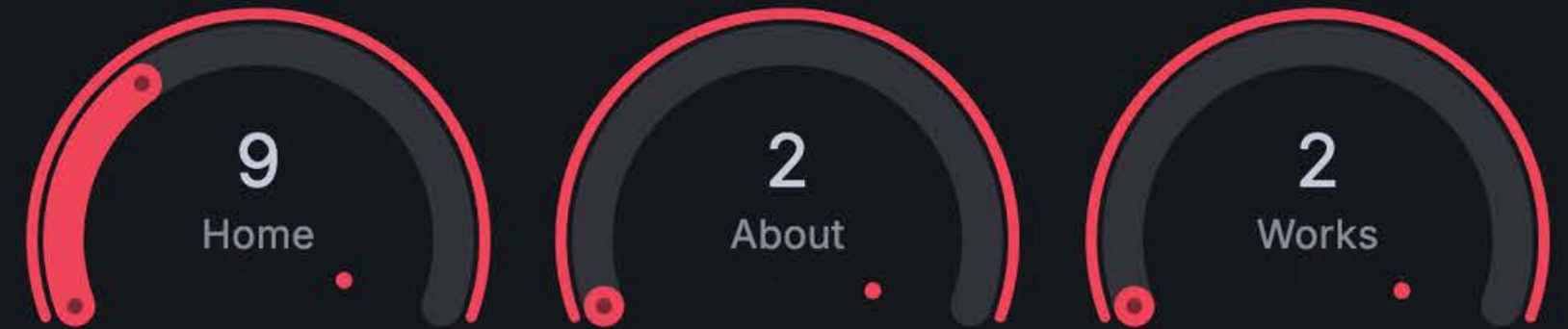
Violations by Severity



Total Violations

13

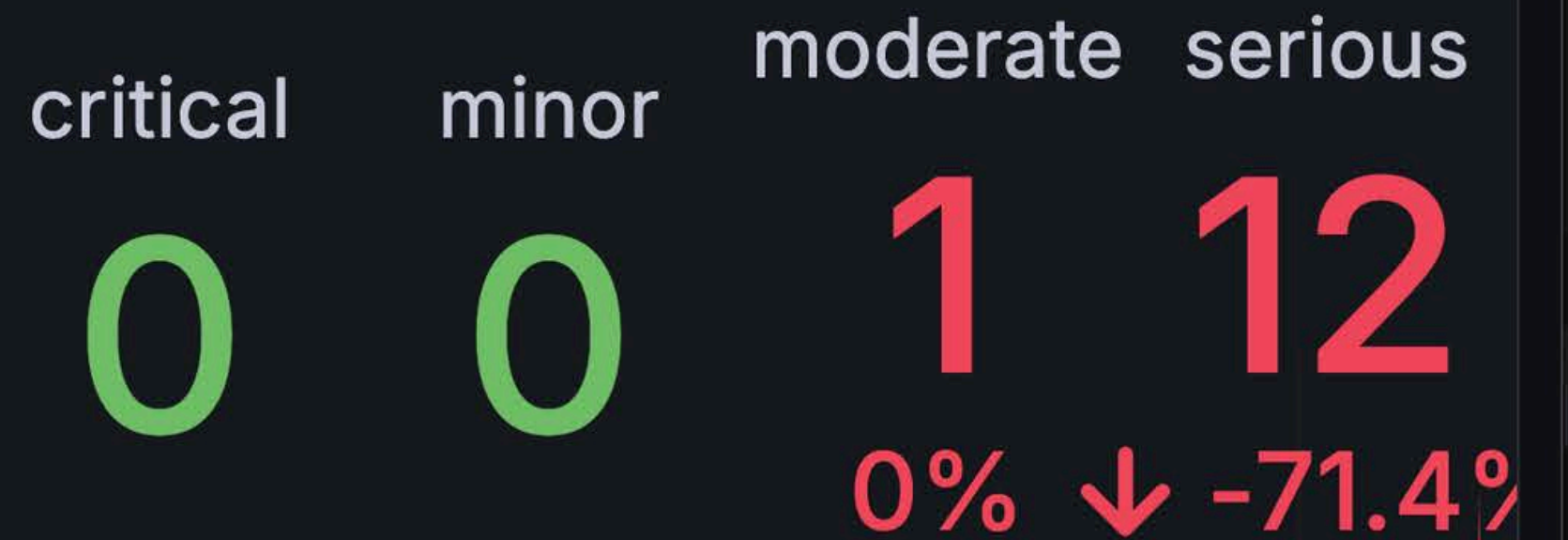
Violations by Page



Accessibility Violations Over Time



Violations by Severity ⓘ





Scan code to view the dashboard

or go to: <https://bit.ly/a11y-dashboard>

~~Four golden signals~~ Five golden signals

Latency

how long it takes to serve a request

Traffic

how much demand is being placed on the system

Accessibility?

how well users with disabilities can successfully interact with your system

Error

the rate of requests that fail

Saturation

how "full" the system is

a measurable rate, tracked over time, that tell you when something has gotten worse.

What will you do next?

Audit

Audit your current process. Are you getting static reports or continuous insight?

Test

Try this on a small project first

Share

Share what you learn from your pilot run or from this talk with your team

Expand

Build momentum from there

Resources

1. [Google SRE book](#)

2. [WCAG 2.1 guidelines](#)

Thank you



VictoriaMetrics



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